# TalonOS

## Technical Reference & Developer SDK Guide

Architecture · hardware · animator CPU · shader GPU · network · TalonSync link · SDK

```
GPU  TalonOS Core shader  ·  3 programs

CPU  FX animator  ·  18 layers

MEM  registers + saved parameters

NET  10 synced bits  ·  TP/Net channel

I/O  contacts · stylus · OSC bus
```




**FOR DEVELOPERS AND AVATAR CREATORS**

Talon Pilot 2.19.6 · TalonOS Nightwing · TalonSync 1.12.0 · Link protocol 3 · Created by NevvyDrone

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01

# Introduction

How Talon Pilot is built, how its parts talk to each other, and how to extend it.

Talon Pilot is a handheld computer that exists entirely inside a VRChat avatar. It has no scripts: VRChat avatars cannot run code. Instead, TalonOS maps a classic computer architecture onto the pieces an avatar is allowed to have. This document describes each of those pieces, the contracts between them, and the developer kit for building on them.

| Computer part | Talon Pilot implementation | Where |
|---|---|---|
| Processor (CPU) | The FX animator controller: state machines whose transitions are the instructions and whose parameter drivers are the writes. | `Editor/TalonPilotAnimator*.cs` |
| Registers / RAM | Material properties on the screen renderer (the register file), plus animator parameters as working memory. | `Shaders/Core/Talon_Registers.cginc` |
| Storage | Saved local expression parameters: typed text, preferences, pet, app settings. They survive avatar reloads. | `TalonPilotWizard.cs (EPar)` |
| GPU / display | The TalonOS Core shader draws the whole 320 × 480 screen every frame from the registers. | `Shaders/Core/*.cginc` |
| ROM | A 32 × 1024 texture: one ASCII line per row (app titles, built-in text, prefs labels, keyboard). | `Editor/TalonPilotRom.cs` |
| Input devices | Contact receivers (touch grid, ink grid, buttons), the stylus senders, Expressions menu, VRChat built-ins. | `Wizard install + Mesh` |
| Network interface | Synced parameters: TP/On, TP/Net (a time-multiplexed 8-bit channel), TP/Beam and TP/JazzAll. | `TalonPilotAnimatorNet.cs` |
| Serial port | The TalonSync link: a clocked, acknowledged bus over OSC parameters. | `TalonPilotAnimatorBus.cs`, `talonsync/bus.py` |

## Audience and scope

- **Avatar creators** who want to understand what Talon Pilot adds to their avatar and what it costs.
- **Developers** who want to add apps, preferences, strings or bus commands to TalonOS, or script TalonSync.
- Everything here describes the shipping source: Unity package `Assets/TalonPilot` and the TalonSync Python application.

## Conventions

- Parameters are written `TP/App`; material registers `_App`; files `Talon_Apps.cginc`.
- Virtual screen coordinates: x 0..320 left to right, y 0..480 top to bottom. The content area of an app is y 28..444.
- Rules marked **RULE** are hard constraints. Breaking them causes compile failures, lag or corrupted saved data.

02

# System Architecture

One avatar, one computer, one OSC link.

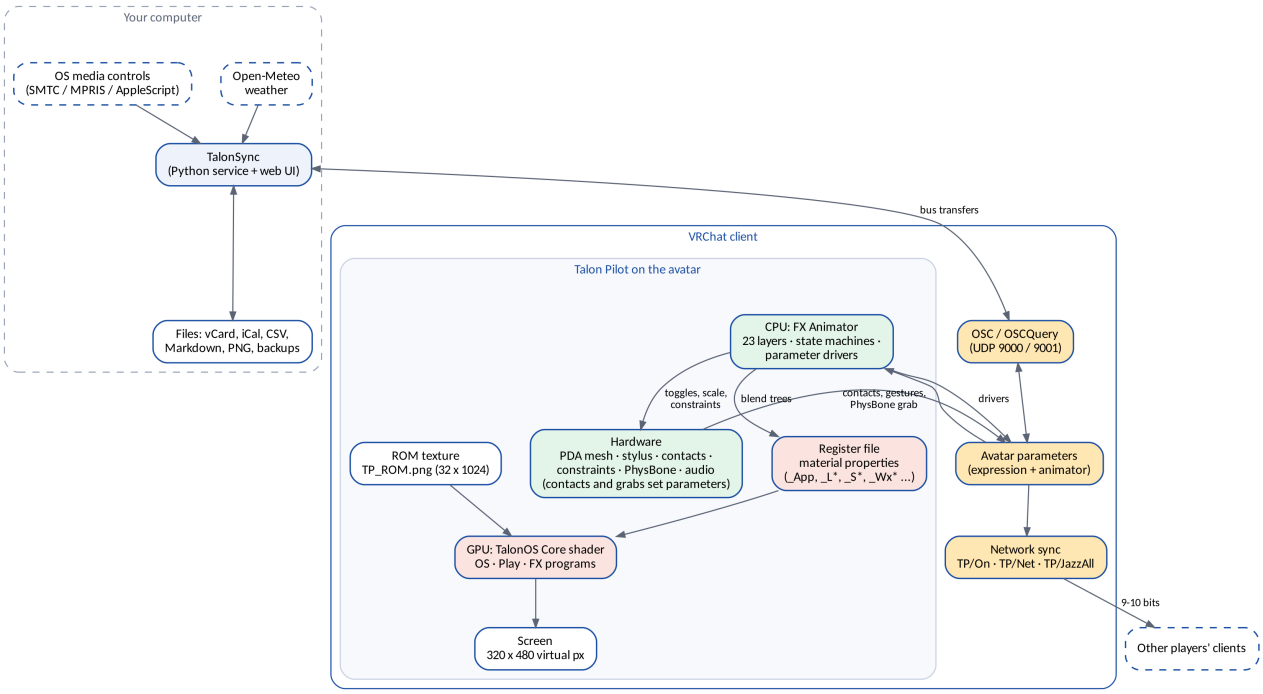



Figure 2-1. System overview: the avatar's components, VRChat, TalonSync and other players.

Every frame, inputs arrive as animator parameters (contacts, menu toggles, OSC writes from TalonSync, VRChat built-ins such as `VRMode` and `Voice`). Animator layers react by changing state; states run parameter drivers that update working parameters. Direct blend trees copy those parameters into material properties on the screen, and the TalonOS Core shader turns the material properties into pixels. Three parameters are synced so other players' copies of the same animator can show your app, theme, size and weather.

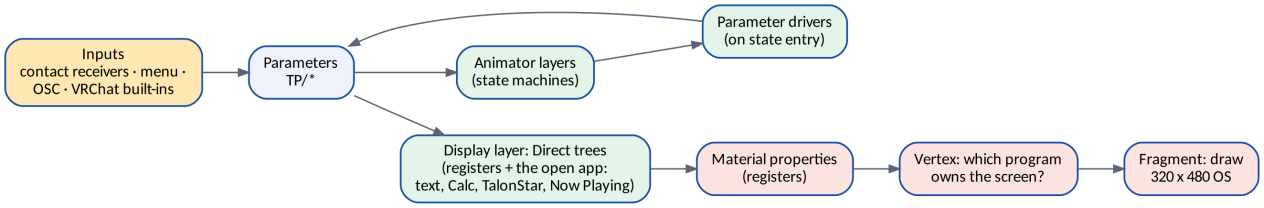



Figure 2-2. One frame, input to pixels.

## Design principles

- **Nothing runs that isn't visible.** Layers park when the PDA is off or on other players' clients; blend trees only animate the app on screen; the shader only runs the program that owns the screen.
- **Local first, sync little.** All of your information lives in unsynced, saved parameters. Only 10 bits (11 with shared jazz) cross the network.

- **Generated, not hand-written.** The animator (about 2,200 states) is built by C# generators; shader tables, registers and strings by Python generators. Edit the generators, then regenerate.
- **Fail safe.** An unknown app shows an error dialog inside the OS; missing optional SDK features fall back (for example, desktop parking without VRC constraints).

03

# Hardware Reference

The physical device: objects, colliders and constraints the wizard builds.

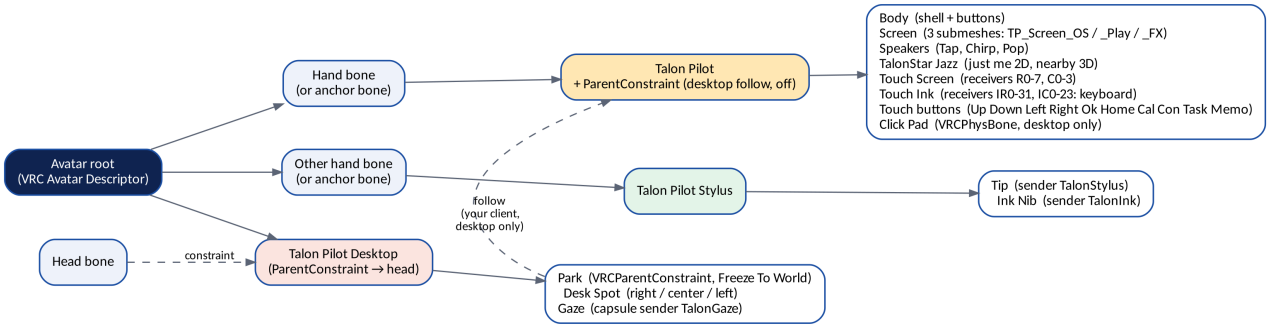



Figure 3-1. GameObject hierarchy created by the Install Wizard.

## Physical model

| Part | Size (1× scale, metres) | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Body | 0.078 × 0.121 × 0.015 (Classic) | Lies flat in its local space: X width, Z length (top at +Z), screen faces +Y. 2.13 case styles: Slim Metal 78×121×11, Rugged Field 86×131×19 (+ bumpers), Retro Brick 84×134×24, Clear Plastic = Classic. The top face, screen and buttons are identical on all of them; submesh 0 shell, 1 accents. UV0 is a box projection for the 2.14 finishes (8 cm per repeat, running along the length); UV1 carries the logo print on the back (neutral grey everywhere else), used by the Standard shader's Detail Albedo x2. |
| Screen | 0.058 × 0.087 (2:3) | X −0.029..0.029, Z −0.0325..0.0545. UV (0,0) bottom-left; one quad, three submeshes. |
| App buttons | X ±0.0295, ±0.0175 | On the button row at Z −0.046, with the 5-way navigator between them. |
| Stylus | Length 0.125 | Tip at +Z. Tip sender radius 3 mm; Ink Nib radius 0.7 mm. 2.14: a custom model is fitted by TalonPilotMesh.FitStylus(): longest side -> +Z, scaled to 0.125, the narrower end at the tip, centred on the axis (a handedness-preserving axis mapping, so faces keep their winding); the Stylus object, Tip and Ink Nib never move. |
| Wizard size | 0.75 to 3 × (default 1.5 ×) | Then 60 to 160 % in game (Prefs › Size & Power); contacts scale with it. |

## Input contacts

All receivers are local-only (`localOnly = true`, `allowSelf = true`, `allowOthers = false`), Constant type, and use Box shapes where the SDK supports them (capsules otherwise). Touch slabs reach 2 mm above the glass and 6 mm below it, so pushing into the screen still counts.

| Receiver set | Parameters | Listens to | Purpose |
|---|---|---|---|
| Touch Screen (12) | `TP/In/R0..R7, TP/In/C0..C3` | TalonInk (+ fingers, TalonGaze) | Coarse grid: rows of 50 px from y 36, columns of 80 px. |
| Touch Ink (56) | `TP/In/IR0..IR31, TP/In/IC0..IC23` | TalonInk (+ fingers, TalonGaze) | Fine grid over x 8..312, y 40..440: the keyboard. |

| Receiver set | Parameters | Listens to | Purpose |
|---|---|---|---|
| Buttons (10) | `TP/In/Up, Down, Left, Right, Ok, Home, Cal, Con, Task, Memo` | TalonStylus (+ fingers, TalonGaze) | Hardware buttons; Home is the house on the silkscreen. |

A tap is a row AND a column at the same time. Physical buttons listen to the wide stylus tip; the screen listens to the fine nib, which makes taps pinpoint accurate.

## Constraints, PhysBone and audio

| Component | On | Behaviour |
|---|---|---|
| ParentConstraint → head | Talon Pilot Desktop | Static: holds the desktop anchor at the head (never parented, because VRChat shrinks your own head locally). |
| VRCParentConstraint (no sources) | Park | Animated Freeze To World parks the desktop spot in the world. Added by reflection; skipped on SDKs without VRC constraints. |
| ParentConstraint (disabled) | Talon Pilot | Source: Desk Spot. Enabled only on your client in desktop mode, so the real PDA moves in front of you. |
| VRCPhysBone | Click Pad | Immobile, grabbable, parameter TP/Desk/Click → _IsGrabbed is the desktop mouse click. Active only in desktop mode. |
| AudioSource ×3 | Speakers | Tap, Chirp, Pop: 3D, toggled by the Beep and Power layers. |
| AudioSource ×2 | TalonStar Jazz | 2D 'just me' (only your client turns it on) and 3D 'nearby' (others' clients, when TP/JazzAll). |

> **NOTE**
> PhysBones on your avatar that contain the PDA or stylus (for example a wing chain) get them added to their Ignore Transforms automatically, so the PDA doesn't swing with the bones.

04

# CPU: The Animator

18 layers in your FX controller, generated by TalonPilotAnimator.

Talon Pilot's layers are prefixed `TP` and appended to your FX controller (backed up first). Every layer except the screen trees uses Write Defaults OFF with an empty 1/60 s clip; the register trees use Write Defaults ON so registers fall back to their material defaults.

| Layer | Role | Others' clients | PDA off |
|---|---|---|---|
| Display (+ app data) | The always-on register tree, plus in each state the open app's text (2 chars / register), Calc, Now Playing or TalonStar tree. Off: nothing evaluated. | Registers only (TalonStar: shared tree) | Paused |
| Net Receive / App / Net Send | Decode TP/Net · map TP/App → _App · encode TP/Net | Runs / runs / idle | Runs / runs / parked |
| Audio · Power · Beep | Speakers, power states, tap beeps | Run / run / parked | Run / run / parked |
| Sync Screen · TalonSync Bus | TalonSync handshake and the OSC bus | Parked | Run (PC can wake) |
| Input | All button, tap and key handling (~900 states) | Parked | Parked |
| Idle · Stopwatch | Screensaver / auto-off timers · stopwatch | Parked | Parked / runs |
| Pet Life · Pet Anim | Hoot Pet needs and animations | Parked | Run |
| Size | PDA + stylus scale (VR) or desktop scale | Runs | Runs |
| Desktop ×2 | Desktop (mode + gaze press), Desktop Park (the spot is in Size). The optional cursor joystick adds Cursor, Tap, Rows, Cols | Parked | Parked |
| TalonSync (optional) | One-time data load after Apply to avatar sends your data | — | — |

## Parking

Parking adds an AnyState transition (checked first) to a parked state with a single way back. Remote parking uses `IfNot IsLocal`; power parking adds `IfNot TP/On`. Measured per-frame transition checks: about 215 with the PDA on, 120 off, 115 for other players.

## Input dispatch

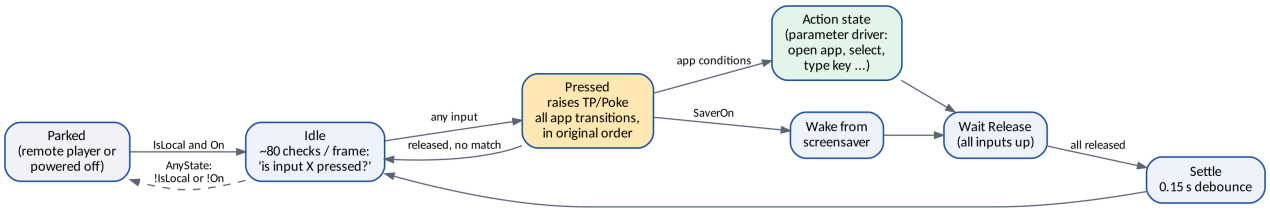



Figure 4-1. Input layer: the Pressed hub keeps idle checks to one per input.

Generators call `On(button, action, conds)`, `Tap(row, col, action, conds)`, `TapRow`, `TapAny` and `Stepper(...)`. Each creates a transition from Idle; `HubInput()` then moves every transition that needs a held input into the Pressed hub, preserving order, and gives Idle one `If TP/In/x` transition per input. Actions are shared by name

(`Action(name, drivers)`), exit to Wait Release and debounce for 0.15 s.

> **RULE**
> Unity compares Int parameters against whole-number thresholds. `FixIntConditions` rewrites every Int Greater/Less so that 'Less 0.5' means == 0 and 'Greater 0.5' means ≥ 1, exactly as in VRChat.

## Power, idle and desktop state machines

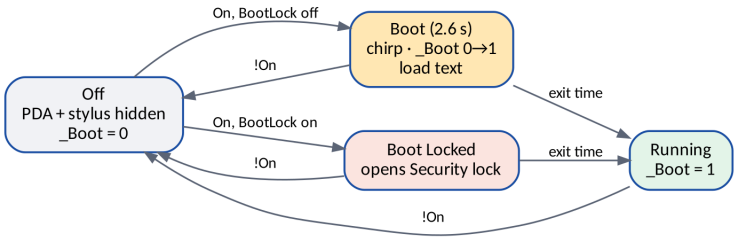



Figure 4-2. Power layer.

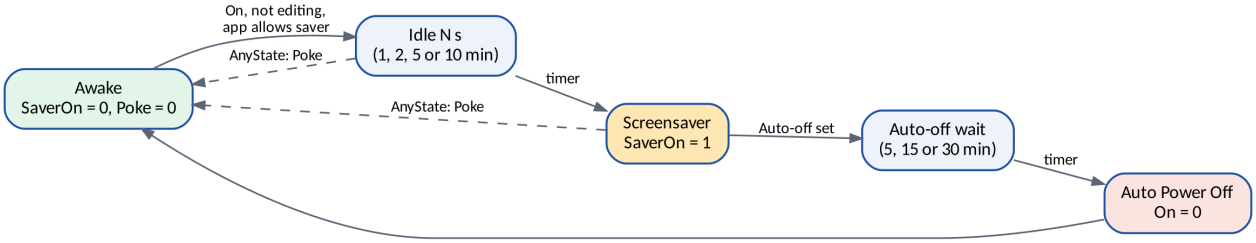



Figure 4-3. Idle layer: screensaver and auto-off. Any input raises TP/Poke.

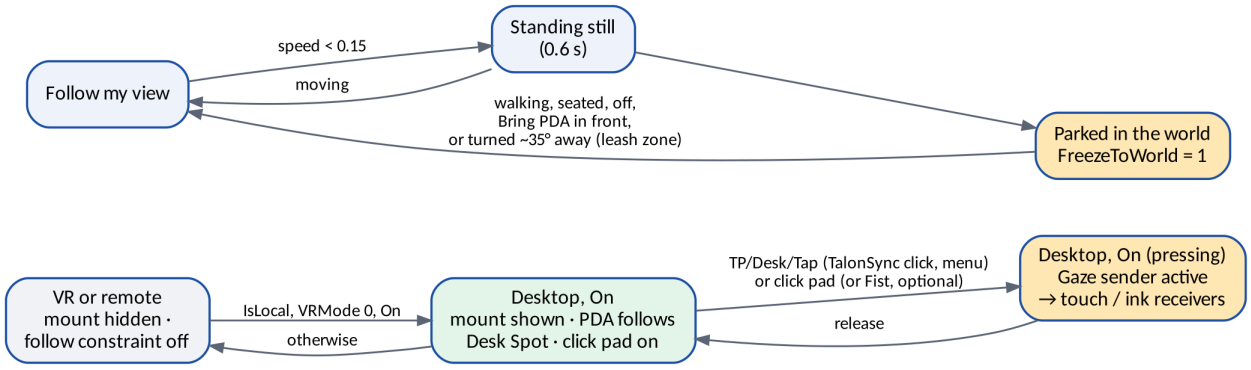



Figure 4-4. Desktop mode: the Desktop layer (mode and gaze press) and Desktop Park.

05

# Memory: Parameters and Registers

What is stored, what is synced, and how values reach the screen.

## Parameter budget

| Group | Type | Count | Synced | Saved |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `TP/On` | Bool | 1 | yes (1 bit) | yes |
| `TP/Net` | Int | 1 | yes (8 bits) | no |
| `TP/JazzAll` | Bool | 1 | yes (1 bit, if jazz is installed) | no |
| `TP/Beam` | Bool | 1 | yes (1 bit): "I'm beaming" | no |
| `TP/App, TP/Bright, TP/Theme, TP/Sound, TP/Hour, TP/Min` | Int / Float | 6 | no | yes (App no) |
| `TP/S/* preferences` | Int | 17 | no | yes |
| `Text: TP/Tx/s_i (48 slots × 15) and TP/XL/s` | Float / Int | 768 | no | yes |
| `Tasks TP/T0-7, app settings, pet` | Float / Int | ~19 | no | yes |
| `TalonSync link (TP/Bus/*, TP/Sync/*)` | mixed | ~48 | no | no |
| `Desktop (TP/Desk/Tap, Here; with the cursor option also X, Y, Aim, CTap)` | Bool / Float | 2 (6) | no | no |
| `Animator-only working parameters` | mixed | ~270 | — | — |

## Text slots

Text is stored as 48 saved slots of 15 characters, right-aligned (the keyboard shifts characters in from the right). Each character is a saved Float holding `code / 127`, which survives VRChat's float storage exactly.

| Slots | Owner | Display lines |
|---|---|---|
| 0-7 | Tasks | 0-7 |
| 8-22 | Memos (5 memos × 3 lines) | 8-22 |
| 23 | Hypno caption | 24 |
| 24-35 | Calendar (6 events × 2 lines) | 25-36 |
| 36-47 | Contacts (6 × 2) | 37-48 |
| — | Keyboard edit buffer | 23 |
| — | Now Playing (TalonSync) | 49-50 |
| — | TalonStar city, ticker | 51, 52-54 |

### Display encoding: two characters per register

```
_L{line}_{k} = char(2k) * 128 + char(2k+1)          k = 0..7   (k = 7 holds char 14 only)
max value 127 * 128 + 127 = 16383  ->  float32 holds it to ~0.001

decode (Talon_LCodeOf):
    v  = register k = floor(i / 2)
```

```
hi = floor((v + 0.5) / 128)
code = (i even) ? hi : round(v - hi * 128)
```

Only one app is on screen at a time, so the 55 display lines share a 16-line window of registers (`Talon_LineWindow` in the shader, `LineWindow` in C#): each app's lines start at window line 0, and the keyboard's edit line is window line 15. That is 128 registers instead of 440.

> **RULE**
> Never pack three characters per register. Values up to two million amplify float rounding in saved weights enough to change letters ('Good' became 'food' in 2.5.2).

## The register file

| Registers | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `_App, _Boot, _Theme, _Bright, _Sound, _HourOff, _MinOff` | System state |
| `_Cursor, _Sel, _View, _Edit, _EPage, _PCat` | App navigation |
| `_S0 .. _S22` | Preference display copies (float mirrors of TP/S/*) |
| `_T0 .. _T7` | Task done flags |
| `_CalcKey, _CalcA, _CalcK, _CalcT, _CalcPh, _CalcB0-7, _CalcOp0-7` | Calculator |
| `_L0_0 .. _L15_7` | Text: a 16-line screen window (see above) |
| `_Wx*, _WxF0-9, _WxPage, _WxJazz` | TalonStar 4000 |
| `_Sync, _SyncStage, _NPPos` | TalonSync screen, Now Playing position |
| `_SaverOn, _SW, _HypSpeed, _HypStyle, _ScopeMode, _Voice, _Speed, _3D*` | Apps and screensaver |
| `_Orb, _SkyPage, _SkyHr, _SkyLat, _SkyLon, _PC0 .. _PC6, _PCPage, _BeamTx` | Owl Oracle, Moon & Stars, PC Link (two values per register: _PC{k/2} = v(2k)*256 + v(2k+1), raw 0-255, 255 = not available; value 5, the low half of _PC2, also drives the title-bar battery), Beam |
| `_Pet*` | Hoot Pet |
| `_TouchX, _TouchY, _TouchP, _TouchHover` | Desktop cursor (optional) |
| `_WallTex, _WallPic, _WallDim` | Wallpaper picture (2.13, static, set by the wizard) |
| `_CTheme{0-2}{Bg,Fg,Ac,Ai,Fc}, _CThemeInv` | Custom themes 5-7 (2.13, static material colours; declared in Talon_Common.cginc) |
| `_Launch0, _Launch1, _Launch2` | The launcher table (2.14, static): item 0-31 -> app id, 3 items per float, 6 bits each, stored as id + 3 (0 Back, 1 More, 2 empty). Written by the wizard from TalonPilotAnimator.LauncherFloats(); the default is every app |
| `_SBState, _SBT, _SBPhase, _SBS0-2, _SBA0-2, _SBScore, _SBLives, _SBBest, _SBPop, _SBPopT` | TalonPop (2.15.2): round state, round ticks (0.4 s) and tick phase, each star's slot and age in ticks, score, lives, best, last pop |
| `_GlobeT, _GlobeScene` | Snow Globe (2.15): seconds since the last shake + 1 (0 = settled), scene 0 day / 1 dusk / 2 night |
| `_BootRes` | Power-on self-test report (2.17): (165 + 256 x flags) / 65536, only while booting |
| `_AquaT, _AquaX, _AquaLight` | Aquarium (2.16): seconds since feeding + 1 (0 = never), feeding column 0-3, lights 0 day / 1 sunset / 2 night |

| Registers | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `_AppsOff` | Apps left out (2.14; 2.16 adds 14-19): bit (id - 20) for apps 20-31, bit (id - 2) for apps 14-19 |
| `_AppsOff` | Apps left out (2.14, static): bit (id - 20). Talon_AppInstalled() treats them as not installed, so a stray open shows the error dialog |
| `_SysError, _ScrimAlpha` | Error handler |

Register reads by index go through generated binary-search functions (`Talon_S(i)`, `Talon_Task(i)`, `Talon_GetLine(i)` …). Constant indices fold away at compile time.

06

# GPU: The TalonOS Core Shader

One shader, three programs, one 320 × 480 screen.

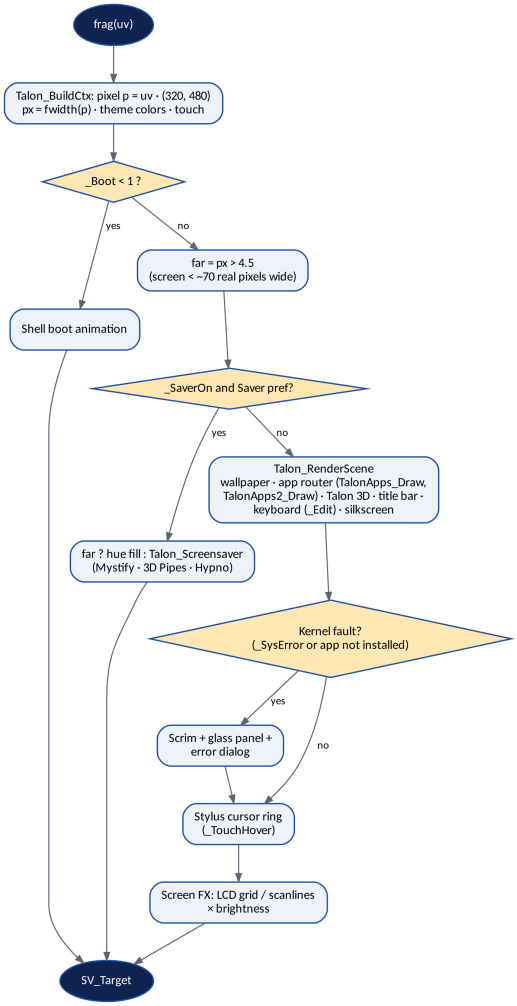



Figure 6-1. Fragment pipeline.

## Programs and screen ownership

The screen mesh has three identical submeshes with three materials: `TP_Screen_OS`, `TP_Screen_Play` and `TP_Screen_FX`. Each enables one local keyword (`TALON_PART_OS`, `TALON_PART_PLAY`, `TALON_PART_FX`) so it compiles only its own apps. The vertex shader of the programs that don't own the current screen moves its quad out of clip space, so only one program shades pixels.

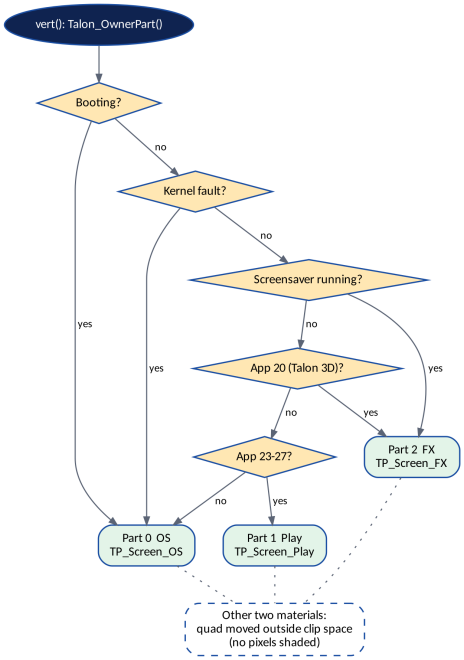



Figure 6-2. Talon_OwnerPart(): which program draws.

| Program | Apps | DXIL instructions |
|---|---|---|
| OS | Power-on self-test, launcher (0), Calendar 1, Contacts 2, Tasks 3, Memos 4, Calc 5, Clock 6, Prefs 7, TalonSync 8, Expense 10, Card Info 11, Security 12, error dialog, keyboard | ≈ 16,000 |
| Play | TalonPop 21, Hypno 23, Compass 24, Scope 25 (nine styles), Hoot Pet 26, TalonStar 27, Owl Oracle 28, Beam 31, keyboard | ≈ 17,400 |
| FX | Aquarium 19, Talon 3D 20, Snow Globe 22, Moon & Stars 29, PC Link 30 (moved from OS in 2.14), screensavers (Mystify, 3D Pipes, Hypnospiral) | ≈ 18,700 |
| (no keyword) | Everything, for previews and older materials | ≈ 38,000 |

# Modules

| File | Contents |
|---|---|
| `TalonOS_Core.shader` | Generated from the template: properties, vertex ownership, kernel router, fragment pipeline. |
| `Talon_Common.cginc` | TalonCtx, SDF primitives, coverage helpers (T_Rect, T_RRect, T_Seg …), program-part macros. |
| `Talon_Registers.cginc` | Generated register declarations and index-search functions. |
| `Talon_FntMgr.cginc` | ROM text, glyphs, numbers, user lines (TalonLine), icon atlas. |
| `Talon_Strings.cginc` | Generated compiled-in strings (TALON_S_*). |
| `Talon_Tables.cginc` | Generated prefs metadata and the keyboard layout. |
| `Talon_Shell.cginc` | Themes, title bar, keyboard overlay, silkscreen, boot, screen FX. |
| `Talon_Apps.cginc / Talon_Apps2.cginc` | Built-in apps and the extension pack, with their routers. |
| `Talon_Star.cginc · Talon_Pet.cginc` | TalonStar 4000 and Hoot Pet. |

| File | Contents |
|---|---|
| `Talon_Screensaver.cginc` · `Talon_3DMgr.cginc` | Screensavers; SDF raymarcher and wireframe renderer. |
| `Talon_CompMgr.cginc` · `Talon_Time.cginc` | Panels, shadows and glass; VRChat time decoding (UTC, local offset, dates). |

## The app contract

```
float3 TalonApp_MyApp(TalonCtx c, float3 col)
{
    // c.p   : this pixel in virtual px (x 0..320, y 0..480)
    // c.px  : one real pixel in virtual px (use for anti-aliasing: Talon_Fill(c, d))
    // c.bg, c.fg, c.accent, c.face, c.hilite ... : theme colors
    // draw only the content area, y 28..444; the shell draws the title bar and silkscreen
    col = lerp(col, c.fg, Talon_StrCentered(c, float2(160, 200), TALON_S_MYAPP_HELLO, 1.0));
    return col;
}
```

## Shader coding rules

- **No dynamically indexed arrays of runtime values.** They become per-pixel scratch memory. Use generated binary-search functions or selects. Static const tables are fine (they become immediate constant buffers).
- **Draw each primitive once per pixel (the slots pattern).** Decide which string, number or icon this pixel can belong to, then call the drawing routine once. FXC inlines every call site.
- **Fetch a text line once** (Talon_GetLine) and pass the TalonLine around.
- **Derivatives only in uniform control flow**: use c.px, computed once in Talon_BuildCtx.
- **No HLSL reserved words as identifiers**: pass, line, point, sample, shared, groupshared, texture, compile ...
- **Branch on registers with Is(v, n)**, which tests 'equals small integer' with a ±0.5 tolerance.

## ROM map

| Rows | Contents |
|---|---|
| `0-31` | App titles (ROW_TITLE) |
| `32 + (app−1)·64` | Per-app blocks: built-in records, help text, stage names |
| `900-929` | Theme names, game text, TalonSync messages, keyboard words |
| `930-937` | Prefs categories |
| `940-959, 1017-1019` | Pref labels (index < 20, then 20+) |
| `960-999` | Pref value labels |
| `1000-1009` | Keyboard rows and key captions |
| `1010-1016` | About text |

07

# Network: What Other Players See

Ten bits, multiplexed.

VRChat syncs Bools as 1 bit and Ints/Floats as 8 bits. Talon Pilot syncs `TP/On`, `TP/Net`, `TP/Beam` and optionally `TP/JazzAll`. `TP/App` itself is local; the Net Send layer takes turns writing typed messages into `TP/Net`, and every other client latches each type into its own parameter.

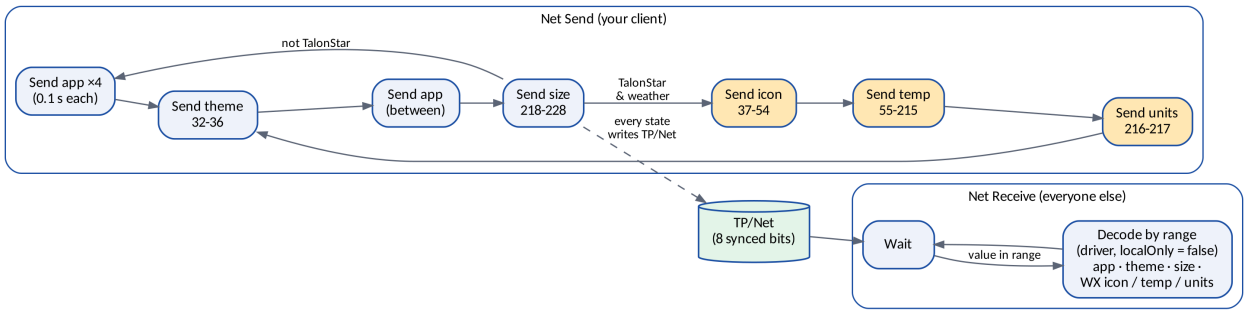



Figure 7-1. TP/Net send loop and receive decoder.

| TP/Net value | Message | Decoded into |
|---|---|---|
| `0 - 31` | Open app | `TP/App` |
| `32 - 36` | Theme 0-4 | `TP/SF/Theme` |
| `37 - 54` | TalonStar icon: 37 + icon·2 + daytime | `TP/WX/Icon (+0.5 = day), App 27` |
| `55 - 215` | TalonStar temperature −40..120 (your units) | `TP/WX/T (temp + 100), Valid = 2, App 27` |
| `216 - 217` | Units °F / °C | `TP/WX/Units, App 27` |
| `218 - 228` | PDA size 60..160 % | `TP/SF/Size` |
| `229 - 231` | Custom theme 5-7 (2.13) | `TP/SF/Theme` |
| `232 - 255` | Spare for extensions | — |

App messages repeat every 0.1 s for four ticks, so switches show up within about a quarter of a second; other messages take 0.25 s slots. The receiver re-applies the last value every couple of frames with drivers that have `localOnly = false`.

> **NOTE**
> Your city name, forecast, ticker, text and pet are never sent. Other players' TalonStar shows a single 'Live from this PDA' page.

## Beam: data over contacts

Avatars can't read each other's parameters, so Beam carries a message between two Talon Pilots on contacts. The sender's own client steps through the message on `TP/Net` (0.4 s per symbol) and raises the synced bit `TP/Beam`, which tells every other client to stop decoding `TP/Net` as app and theme messages.

| Where | What happens |
|---|---|
| Sender, own client | Net Send: preamble (128), start (2), the 15 characters, end (3). Bit 7 toggles on every symbol: it is the clock. |
| Sender's avatar, on every other client | Net Receive copies TP/Net into `TP/NetF`; a Display-layer state plays a 1D blend tree with 256 children that switches 8 contact senders (`TalonBeam0-7`) on the PDA to that symbol's bits. |
| Receiver, own client | 8 local receivers (others only) feel the senders when the PDAs are within about a hand's width. Each toggle of bit 7 latches bits 0-6 through one decode state (128 transitions, checked only on that frame), then stores the character. Start clears the inbox, end opens Beam and chirps. |

Cost: 1 synced bit, 16 contacts, about 30 parameters and no layers. When nobody is beaming, the only per-frame work is one transition check.

08

# The TalonSync Link Protocol

A clocked serial bus made of avatar parameters. Protocol version 3.

TalonSync and the PDA talk only through avatar parameters over OSC. The PC drives the bus; the PDA's TalonSync Bus layer answers. VRChat only reports parameters that change, so before a read the PC writes sentinel values to the data lines; anything still at its sentinel is known to be unchanged.

## Signals

| Parameter | Type | Direction | Meaning |
|---|---|---|---|
| `TP/Bus/Addr` | Int | PC → PDA | Port address 0-254 |
| `TP/Bus/Clk` | Bool | PC → PDA | Raised to start a transfer |
| `TP/Bus/Ack` | Int | PDA → PC | 1 done, 2 unknown address, 0 released |
| `TP/Bus/Len, V, N` | Int, Float, Int | both | Length / small value; float value; integer value |
| `TP/Bus/C0-14` | Int | both | Characters (one line) |
| `TP/Bus/B0-23` | Bool | both | Ink row bits (older PDAs with a Note Pad only) |
| `TP/Sync/Req` | Bool | PDA → PC | The PDA's TalonSync button is waiting |
| `TP/Sync/State` | Int | PC → PDA | 0 idle, 1 PC wants to sync, 2 transferring, 3 done, 4 failed |
| `TP/Sync/Stage, Prog` | Float | PC → PDA | Stage / 8 and progress 0..1 for the PDA's screen |

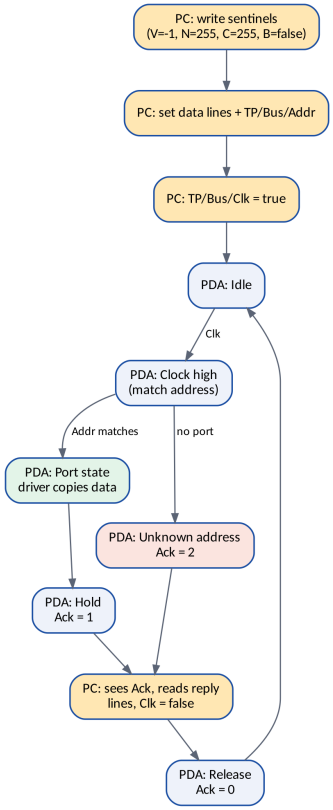



Figure 8-1. One bus transfer.

# Address map

| Address | Operation |
|---|---|
| `0 - 13` | PC Link value k (Len, raw 0-255; 255 = not available): CPU, GPU, CPU °C, GPU °C, RAM, headset, left, right, heart bpm, timer minutes, timer fraction, timer state, unread |
| `14, 15` | PC Link message lines (C0-14) |
| `16` | Alert: the PDA chirps |
| `17` | Clear the PC Link messages |
| `18, 19` | Moon & Stars latitude (Len - 90) and longitude (Len / 255 × 360 - 180) |
| `0 - 63 (protocol 2)` | Note Pad ink rows, on PDAs before 2.10 |
| `64 - 111` | Write text slot s (C0-14, Len) |
| `112 - 159` | Read text slot s |
| `160 - 199` | Read value k (V for floats, N for ints/bools) |
| `200` | Ping: N = protocol version |
| `201` | Reload display copies (after writing prefs) |
| `202` | Clear the Note Pad (PDAs before 2.10) |
| `203, 204` | Now Playing line 0 / 1 |
| `205` | Now Playing position (Len / 255) |
| `206` | Now Playing clear |
| `207 - 246` | Write value k (Len; floats Len / 255) |
| `247` | Open app Len (and power on) |
| `248` | Weather now (C0-14) |
| `249` | Forecast (C0-9) |
| `250` | City name |
| `251` | Jazz mode (Len / 2) |
| `252 - 254` | Ticker lines 0-2 |

### Value table (addresses 160 + k and 207 + k)

k 0-19: the first 20 preferences in table order (Hour, Minute, Clock24, Bright, Theme, Wall, FX, Sound, Vol, TapBeep, GameSnd, Btn1-4, Saver, SaverTime, AutoOff, BootLock, ClockSrc); 20-25: app settings (3D model, look, spin; Hypno speed, style; Scope mode); 26-33: task flags; 34: power; 35-39: pet (food, joy, energy, age, asleep).

> **RULE**
> The value table is exactly 40 entries and both sides depend on its order. New preferences are appended to the prefs table but kept off the bus (TalonPilotSettings.BusPrefs = 20).

# A TalonSync session

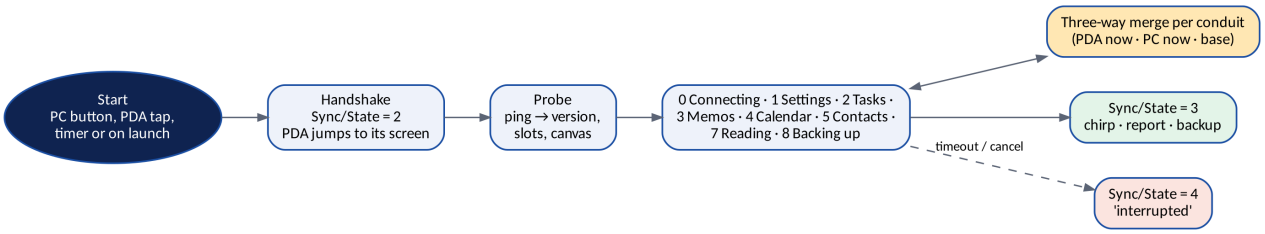



Figure 8-2. Sync session stages.

09

# TalonSync Software Architecture

A Python service with a web front end.

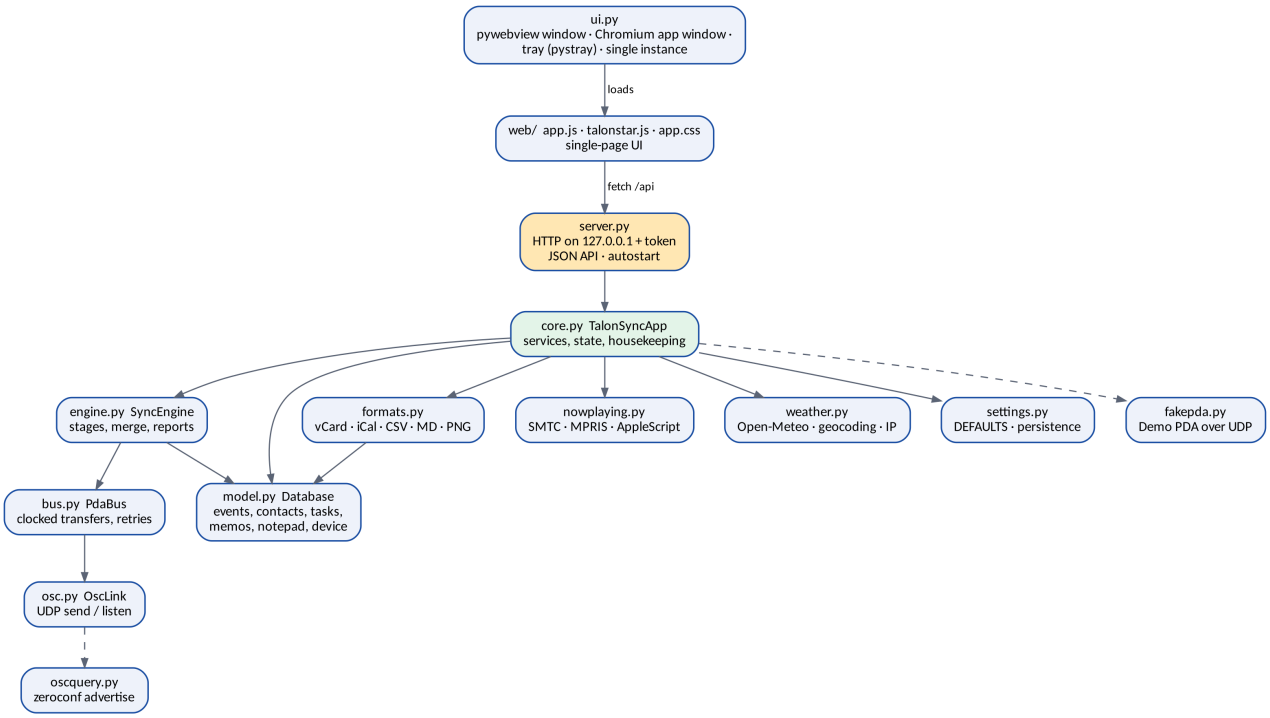



Figure 9-1. TalonSync modules.

| Module | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| `talonsync_main.py` | Entry point and command-line options: --minimized, --browser, --port, --data, --demo, --headless. |
| `core.py` | TalonSyncApp: owns settings, database, OSC link, bus, sync engine, Now Playing, weather and housekeeping; builds the UI state. |
| `engine.py` | SyncEngine: runs a session through its stages and conduits, three-way merges, reports and backups. |
| `bus.py` | PdaBus: clocked transfers with sentinels, timeouts and retries; high-level operations. |
| `protocol.py` | Parameter names, addresses, stages, slot map and the value table: must match the Unity package. |
| `osc.py / oscquery.py` | UDP OSC send and receive; OSCQuery advertising over zeroconf. |
| `model.py / formats.py` | Records and the file formats (vCard, iCalendar, CSV, Markdown, PNG, JSON). |
| `nowplaying.py / weather.py` | Media sources per OS; Open-Meteo forecasts, geocoding and IP location. |
| `server.py / ui.py / web/` | Local HTTP API with a per-run token; window, tray and autostart; the single-page interface. |
| `fakepda.py` | Demo PDA: a pretend Talon Pilot that speaks the bus over UDP. |

## Scripting the PDA from Python

```
from talonsync.osc import OscLink
from talonsync.bus import PdaBus, Timing

link = OscLink(send_port=9000, listen_port=9001)       # VRChat's default ports
link.start()
bus = PdaBus(link, Timing(ack_timeout=1.0))

print("protocol", bus.ping())                        # 2
bus.open_app(27)                                     # open TalonStar 4000
bus.write_text(0, "Bake lightmaps")                  # task slot 0
bus.reload()                                         # refresh the display copies
bus.now_playing("Midnight Glide", "The Night Owls", position=0.25)
bus.ticker("Doors open at 9 pm in the Aerie!")
```

| PdaBus method | Address(es) | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `ping() → int` | `200` | Protocol version |
| `probe() → PdaInfo` | `200, 160+` | Version, text slots, canvas size |
| `read_text(slot) / write_text(slot, text)` | `112+s / 64+s` | 15 ASCII characters, right-aligned on the PDA |
| `read_ink_row(r, cols) / write_ink_row(r, bits) / clear_ink()` | `32+r / 0+r / 202` | Note Pad rows (PDAs before 2.10) |
| `read_value(k) / write_value(k, v)` | `160+k / 207+k` | See the value table |
| `reload()` | `201` | After writing prefs |
| `now_playing(title, artist, position) / now_position(p) / now_clear()` | `203-206` | |
| `open_app(app)` | `247` | Also powers the PDA on |
| `weather(w) / ticker(text) / jazz_mode(mode)` | `248-254` | TalonStar |
| `pc_value(k, raw) / pc_message(title, text) / pc_alert() / pc_clear()` | `0-17` | PC Link (protocol 3) |
| `sky_location(lat, lon)` | `18, 19` | Moon & Stars |
| `set_state(s) / set_stage(stage, progress)` | `TP/Sync/*` | Drive the PDA's TalonSync screen |

> **TIP**
> Only one program should drive the bus at a time. Quit TalonSync (or use its Demo PDA) before running your own scripts against VRChat.

10

# Developer SDK Guide

Extending TalonOS: the toolchain and step-by-step recipes.

## The toolchain

Generated files must not be edited by hand. The generators ship in `Assets/TalonPilot/SDK/Generators` and write into the package (override the location with the `TALONPILOT_ROOT` environment variable). They need Python 3.8 or newer and no extra packages.

| Generator | Writes | Source of truth for |
|---|---|---|
| `gen_tables.py` | `Editor/TalonPilotSettings.cs`, `Shaders/Core/Talon_Tables.cginc` | Preferences, categories, About text, keyboard layout |
| `gen_registers.py` | `Shaders/Core/Talon_Registers.cginc` (+ properties block) | Every register and the index-search functions |
| `gen_sky.py` | `Shaders/Core/Talon_SkyData.cginc` | The Moon & Stars catalog: bright stars and constellation lines |
| `gen_core.py` | `Talon_Registers.cginc`, `Talon_Strings.cginc`, `TalonOS_Core.shader` | Compiled-in strings; assembles the shader from TalonOS_Core.shader.template |

```
cd Assets/TalonPilot/SDK/Generators
python gen_tables.py        # after changing preferences or the keyboard
python gen_core.py          # after changing registers, strings or the template (also runs gen_registers)
```

Then let Unity reimport, and run the Install Wizard's **Update** on your avatar so the animator is rebuilt from the C# generators.

## Recipe: add a preference

- Append a `pref(...)` line at the end of the list in gen_tables.py (never insert: saved TalonSync data uses table order). Max 4 per category, 27 total.
- Kinds: 1 labels (needs value labels; ROM rows 960-999 are nearly full), 2 number, 3 bar, 4 app name.
- Run gen_tables.py then gen_core.py. The Prefs app, the animator steppers, the display mirror and the expression parameter appear automatically.
- Read it in the shader with `Talon_S(TALON_PREF_MYKEY)`.

## Recipe: add a compiled-in string

```
# gen_core.py, strings list
("MYAPP_HELLO", "Hello from my app"),
# shader
col = lerp(col, c.fg, Talon_StrText(c, float2(20, 60), TALON_S_MYAPP_HELLO, 1.0));
```

## Recipe: add an app

Free app ids are 14-17 (the shared channel carries apps 0-31; 28-31 became Owl Oracle, Moon & Stars, PC Link and Beam in 2.11, 21-22 TalonPop and Snow Globe in 2.15, 19 the Aquarium in 2.16, 18 the Terminal in 2.18). Ids 9 and 13 belonged to the retired Note Pad and Hoot Pop: don't reuse them, because saved button settings may still point at them. The example adds app 17 on launcher page 2, after the Terminal.

**1.** Draw it. Add the function to Talon_Apps2.cginc and route it inside the TP_PLAY block of TalonApps2_Draw:

```
#if TP_PLAY
    ...
    if (Is(app, 17)) { col = TalonApp_MyApp(c, col); return true; }
#endif
```

**2.** Title. Add a string ("T_MYAPP") in gen_core.py and return it from TalonApps2_Title for app 17.

**3.** Ownership. In TalonOS_Core.shader.template, include 17 in Talon_IsExtensionApp and in the Play branch of Talon_OwnerPart:

```
if ((a > 22.5 && a < 28.5) || Is(a, 31) || Is(a, 17)) return 1.0;
```

**4.** Launcher. Add app 17 to a category in LauncherCategories (TalonPilotAnimatorApps.cs) and LAUNCHER_CATEGORIES (gen_registers.py), in the same position (8 slots per category), and draw an icon in TalonIcon_Proc. The launcher table is generated from these lists for both the animator and the material (2.14).

```
new[] { 27, 25, 24, 29, 17 },   // Sky & Tools, C#
[27, 25, 24, 29, 17],            # Sky & Tools, gen_registers.py
```

**5.** Install it. Add 17 to AllApps and a name in AppName (TalonPilotAnimatorApps.cs).

**6.** Input. In a Build*Input method, use the generator helpers with an app condition:

```
var here = L(IEq(P("App"), 17)).ToList();
Stepper("MyApp level", P("My/Level"), 0, 9, 1, false, "Right", "Left", here);
On("Ok", Action("MyApp go", Set(P("My/Go"), 1)), here);
```

**7.** Registers. Declare them in gen_registers.py and feed them from a gated Direct tree, so they cost nothing outside your app:

```
DirectTreeLayer("MyApp Registers", 17, new List<(string, string)> { (P("My/Level"), "_MyLevel") });
```

**8.** Regenerate, Update the avatar, and test in Gesture Manager or Av3Emulator.

> **TIP**
> Saved parameters you add must be listed in the wizard's expression parameter section (EPar) and should be local (synced = false). Put new menu items under the existing Talon Pilot submenu.

## Optional apps (2.14)

Apps 20 and 23-31 can be left out in the wizard. `TalonPilotAnimator.Without` holds the left-out ids and `HasApp(id)` gates everything an app builds: its parameters, its Display state, its input states, its bus ports, its layers (Hoot Pet's two), its Net states (TalonStar's weather, Beam's "I'm beaming" conditions via `NotBeaming()`) and its objects (Beam's contacts, the Oracle's shake PhysBone, the jazz players). The launcher compacts: `LauncherTable(without)` fills page 1 with the first 15 apps and adds More only when there are more. The C# table and the material table come from the same function. Bus addresses of a left-out app answer NAK; TalonSync treats that as "not on this PDA". Keep the 40-entry value table unchanged: value ports whose parameter doesn't exist are simply not built.

When you add an app, decide whether it is optional. If it is, add it to `OptionalApps` and to the wizard's `AppCosts`, gate its Build* calls with `HasApp`, and run the harness's "without" configurations: no condition or driver may reference a missing parameter.

## Power-on self-test (2.17)

Every boot line is a real check, and the boot lasts only as long as the slowest one (VRChat restoring saved memory, TalonSync answering; at most 1.5 s). The Power layer runs a short chain of states that exist only while booting; nothing runs after boot.

| Check | How it is measured |
|---|---|
| ROM | The shader sums one byte from each of the 1024 ROM rows (column (7 r + 3) mod 32) and compares it with the checksum the wizard stores in the ROM itself (row 0, bytes 29-31). Only the pixels of the ROM line run the sum. |
| RAM | POST writes the pattern 165 into `TP/Boot/Res`; the Display layer copies it to `_BootRes` and the shader checks it arrived intact: driver, parameter memory, blend tree, material, GPU. |
| Saved memory | The saved int `TP/Boot/NV` is 165 once a PDA has booted: 165 restored, 0 first boot (then set), anything else bad (then reset). |
| PC link | TalonSync answers power-on by setting `TP/PC/Hello` (its version, 187 = 1.8.7) over OSC, three times within the window. |
| Input, digitizer | VRMode and TrackingType from VRChat; any touch line pressed during POST is reported as held. |
| CPU clock, display, RTC, audio, battery, apps | Shader: 1 / unity_DeltaTime, the real pixel size of the screen, VRChat's time globals, the AudioLink texture, the TalonSync battery value, the launcher table. |

All results travel in one float: `TP/Boot/Res` = (165 + 256 × flags) / 65536, exact in a float. Flags: 1 NVRAM ok, 2 blank (1+2 bad), 4 TalonSync, 8 touch held, 16 VR, 32 full body, 64 finished. The Display layer's "Show POST" state is the first Any State transition and may re-enter itself, so it holds the layer while Res > 0 without adding a condition to any other transition; after boot it costs one failed check a frame. Cost: 3 parameters (+ VRChat's TrackingType), 1 animated value, 0 layers.

## Terminal: the PC as the CPU (2.18)

App 18 is a 30 x 8 character screen for Talon Enhanced BASIC, which runs in TalonSync (talonsync/basic.py, talonsync/terminal.py). TalonSync writes the screen over OSC into 128 local parameters `TP/Term/L{w}_{k}`: row r is text-window lines 2r (columns 0-14) and 2r+1 (15-29), two characters per parameter (c1 × 128 + c2). The Display state copies them straight into the 16-line text-window registers the other text apps use, so the terminal adds one register (`_TermCur`, row × 32 + column, −1 = no PC) and no animated values while closed. Only changed lines are sent, at most about 12 screens a second. BASIC is not started on its own: at power-on, avatar load, TalonSync start or when `TP/App` becomes 18, TalonSync shows a start menu (1 Talon Enhanced BASIC, 2 local terminal with built-in commands); BYE or SYSTEM returns from BASIC to the local terminal. The start menu has three choices since 1.10.2: 1 Program Library (talonsync/library.py), 2 BASIC, 3 local terminal. The CPU is experimental and opt in (TalonSync setting `exp_terminal`, off by default); while it is off TalonSync ignores commands 40-44 and keeps `TP/Term/Cur` at −1.

Typing reuses the QWERTY keyboard (ESlot 98). Done copies the edit buffer into `TP/Bus/C0-14` and `TP/Bus/Len` and sets `TP/PC/Cmd` = 40; 41/42 scroll back and forward, 43 breaks, 44 repeats the last line. A full 15-letter line is joined with the next send. `TP/Term/Beep` plays the chirp (BASIC's BEEP). POST sets `TP/Term/Cur` to −1 and TalonSync redraws when it answers power-on. Cost when installed: about 130 local parameters, 0 layers, two Display states and one Beep-layer check; left out: nothing.

**Line graphics (2.18.2).** Codes 5-31 are not font glyphs on the Terminal: Talon_TermGfx draws them as shapes that fill the whole 10 x 34 character cell (a letter only uses 20 of the 34 units), so lines meet across rows and columns. 5/6/7 shades (25/50/75 %), 8 upper half, 9 lower half, 11 left half, 12 right half, 13 ball, 14 / and 15 \ diagonals, 16 full block, and 17-31 box pieces = 16 + arms (1 up, 2 down, 4 left, 8 right): 19 vertical, 28 horizontal, 26 top-left corner, 31 cross. 10 is the new line and never reaches the PDA. TalonSync maps the Unicode box and block characters to these codes, keeps a cursor so the screen is addressable (LOCATE), and ORs the arms when a line is drawn over a line, so crossings join by themselves. BASIC: LOCATE r,c; BOX r,c,h,w; LINE r1,c1,r2,c2. A line's end on empty ground is drawn full length; on another line it becomes a T.

**TalonOS Enhanced (2.19, TalonSync 1.11).** TalonSync draws a desktop (talonsync/enhanced.py) as 30 x 8 cells of a character and a 5-bit style, packed into the same 128 terminal registers: v = c1 × 128 + c2 + 16384 × (s1 + 32 × s2), still exact in a float. `TP/Term/Cur` ≥ 1000 switches the PDA to desktop mode (≥ 2000: the start-up screen). Talon_TermGui turns cells into 10 × 52-unit tiles: each style has a background, an ink and a bevel family (window, button, pressed, field, taskbar, tray, tooltip, start button); bevels are drawn where a neighbour belongs to another family, so TalonSync only says what each cell is. Anchor styles (20/21 icon, 28 owl, 29 small owl) draw a 30-unit picture over their cell and its neighbours: 'A'-'P' the icon atlas, 'f' folder, 'p' prompt, 'r' bin. Five cell reads per pixel share one inlined fetch; the OS part is about 19.1k instructions. Input: Up/Down 41/42, Left 43 (back), Right 44 (Start menu), Center 45 (Enter, desktop mode only), typed lines 40 as shortcuts. Taps: the 32 + 24 touch-grid contacts (`TP/In/IR0-31`, `TP/In/IC0-23`) are local expression parameters, so VRChat reports them over OSC; TalonSync averages the active rows and columns 90 ms after a touch starts and hit-tests the cell. In desktop mode the animator leaves taps alone.

## Clocks without layers (2.15)

Since 2.17.6 the Snow Globe is a real 3D scene: the glass ball is solved exactly (ray/sphere, Fresnel, refraction into water), then the scene is ray-marched along the short chord inside the ball with bounding tests per object, a 5-tap loop for the normal and ambient occlusion (so the scene code compiles only twice), fewer steps when far away, and snow on five depth layers. It costs less than the 2.15 flat version. It needs a harder shake than the Owl Oracle (GlobeShakeThreshold 0.55).

Snow Globe needs time without adding a layer: its Display state plays a clip that animates the register `_GlobeT`. A shake flips the Gen bool, and the app has two identical Display states (A and B) gated on it, so the flip re-enters a state and restarts the clip.

TalonPop (2.15.2) keeps its game clock in the Idle layer, which only runs the screensaver timer and rests while TalonPop is open: a loop of two 0.4 s tick states. Each tick adds 1 to the round (`TP/SB/T`) and to each star's age (`TP/SB/A{i}`), then checks, in order: leaving, round over (150 ticks or no lives), bursts (age past the star's life), next tick. The tick clip animates `_SBPhase` 0-1 so stars grow smoothly between ticks. The Input layer only handles taps (pop: points by age band), so a game can never hold up the buttons. Taps raise TP/Poke as usual; the Idle layer ignores Poke while a round is running. Whether a score beats the best needs no comparison of two parameters: `TP/SB/D` starts at −Best and every point adds to it, so a new best is D > 0.

The Aquarium (2.16) uses the same trick for its feeding clock (`_AquaT`, flipped by `TP/Aqua/Gen`). Everything else, the fish paths, turning, tail beats and swimming to the food, is worked out in the shader from that one clock, so the animator does no work while you watch. Its loops use [loop] rather than [unroll], so eight detailed fish cost the instructions of one.

## Recipe: add a bus command

- Pick a free address (255 is the only one left: extend by repurposing a range only with a protocol version bump).
- Add a `Port(addr, name, drivers...)` in BuildBus (TalonPilotAnimatorBus.cs); drivers copy from the data lines.
- Add the constant and a PdaBus method in talonsync/protocol.py and bus.py, and teach fakepda.py the address.
- Bump PROTOCOL_VERSION on both sides when an existing meaning changes.

## Compatibility rules

- Never reorder or remove preferences, text slots or value-table entries: saved avatar data and TalonSync backups depend on positions.
- Keep TP/App, TP/On and TP/Net names and types; other players' clients rely on them.
- Keep the text encoding (code / 127 per saved character, two characters per display register).

- Record new animator paths before the animator is built: anything that moves objects (anchors, placements) must run first.
- Keep synced bits at 10 (11 with shared jazz). Add shared information as TP/Net message ranges (232-255 are spare).

## Performance budget

| Resource | Budget | Current |
|---|---|---|
| Transition checks per frame (local, on) | < 400 | ≈ 215 |
| Transition checks per frame (off / remote) | < 200 | ≈ 120 |
| Direct-tree children per frame | < 350 in any app | 61 launcher · 197 Tasks · 302 Memos |
| Animated values (bindings) | < 900 | ≈ 280 |
| Animator parameters | < 1,300 | ≈ 1,200 |
| Layers added to FX | < 25 | 18 |
| Expression parameters | < 1,000 | ≈ 900 |
| Synced bits | ≤ 11 | 10-11 |
| Largest shader program | < 20,000 DXIL | ≈ 18,700 |

**RULE**
On your own avatar, VRChat runs the animator again for your mirror and shadow copies, and community benchmarks put local parameters at about 1.5 ms per 1,000. Parameters and layers cost every frame even while the PDA is off, so they are the budget that matters most. Note Pad (about 200 parameters) and Hoot Pop (about 105 parameters and a layer) were retired in 2.10 for this reason.

## Testing checklist

- Shader compiles with no warnings in all three keyword variants and with no keyword.
- Every app renders the same pixels in its own program as in the all-in-one program.
- Input: each new transition is reachable from the Pressed hub; hold-and-release does not double-fire.
- Remote: with IsLocal false, parked layers stay parked and TP/Net decodes correctly.
- TalonSync: ping, text round-trip, values and any new port against the Demo PDA, then in VRChat.

11

# Appendices

## A. Package layout

```
Assets/TalonPilot/
  Editor/                C# generators: wizard + Control Center, animator (CPU), ROM, mesh, TalonSync push
  Shaders/TalonOS.shader classic shader (v1.6) for minimal installs
  Shaders/Core/          TalonOS Core shader and modules (see chapter 6)
  Textures/              font atlas, icon atlas
  Audio/                 tap, chirp, pop, TalonStar jazz
  SDK/Generators/        Python generators for tables, registers, strings and the shader
  Documentation/         Handbook, Quick Start Guide, this document
  Generated/<avatar>/    created per avatar: materials, meshes, ROM, menus, backups
TalonSync/
  talonsync/             Python package (see chapter 9) and web/ interface
  tests/                 fake-PDA sync, file formats, real-animator bridge tests
  Build TalonSync.bat    Windows build · Run TalonSync.sh / .command for Linux and macOS
```

## B. Glossary

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Register | A material property the shader reads; written by animator blend trees. |
| Mirror | A Float copy of an Int parameter (TP/SF/*), because blend trees only take Floats. |
| Gated layer | A layer whose Direct tree only plays while its app is open, locally. |
| Parked | A layer state with one exit, used for other players and while powered off. |
| Hub | The Input layer's Pressed state, which holds all app transitions. |
| Program / part | One of the three keyword variants of the TalonOS Core shader. |
| Slot | A saved 15-character text line; also the shader pattern of drawing one primitive per pixel. |
| Conduit | One kind of information TalonSync synchronizes (tasks, memos …). |
| Sentinel | A value the PC writes before a bus read, so unchanged replies are detectable. |

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